

Syllabus – ATSP 6009-004 – Grad Projects – Fall 2026

SEMESTER

MFA6009-004 Graduate Projects: Art & Technology / Sound Practices

Format: 7 Individual 60 minute meetings per semester arranged individually

Advising schedule will be determined on an individual basis with your faculty advisor via email.

Faculty:

NAME: Douglas Rosman (he/him) (preferred name: Doug)

TITLE: Assistant Professor, AT/SP

EMAIL: drosman@saic.edu

OFFICE LOCATION: MacLean 405

Course Description:

Graduate Projects advisors are expected to provide committed, one-to-one instruction in the service of enhancing students' research practices and both expanding and deepening their intellectual engagement. References should be made to other practitioners and cultural entities of all types that might productively inform students' practices. Where appropriate, skill building needs should be specified and supported. Creative and intellectual rigor should be expected of each student and modeled by the advising faculty member. Graduate Projects advisors also often function as attentive listeners, and this can be an important and productive form of student support as well.

Learning Goals & Outcomes:

The course develops the habits, discipline, and commitments that underpin an individual practice and production, including establishing resources, time management, and skill building.

The course teaches artists/designers how to make use of the feedback they receive from various sources, revise and reiterate based on feedback, and show academic progress throughout.

The course is designed to reflect on the commentary and responses from the instructor to help artists/designers to articulate a position of their work within its field.

Institutional Policies and Support Services:

SAIC Attendance and Participation Policy

Students are expected to attend all classes regularly and arrive on time. Full participation is required in all aspects of a course—including in-person sessions, synchronous online classes, and independent study.

Instructors may permit students up to two absences per semester—inclusive of absences due to illness and/or family/personal emergencies. If a student registers late during the add/drop period, they are responsible for catching up on all missed content and assignments; instructors may count those missed classes as absences.

Instructors have the discretion to define expectations around student tardiness, including policies related to late arrivals, mid-class breaks, and early departures. These expectations should be clearly outlined in the course syllabus and communicated to students during the first class to ensure transparency and consistency.

Instructors grant credit only to students who meet the standards and expectations of the course.

Students who are ill and unable to attend class should notify their instructor(s) by email or leave a message with the department office on the day they are absent. For extended absences due to illness, the student should contact Health Services, who will notify instructors. For other extenuating circumstances, students should reach out to the Academic Advising office. Please note that the written notification does not excuse a student from classes.

Federal Financial Aid Attendance Requirement

Recipients of federal aid must have begun attendance in classes for which their eligibility is based upon at the time of disbursement and, in the case of Federal Direct Loans (Subsidized, Unsubsidized, and PLUS), be enrolled at least half-time.

Religious Holiday Observance

SAIC recognizes the diverse religious and cultural practices of our community. Students are expected to notify their instructors early in the semester to discuss reasonable accommodations for holidays they observe.

Class Progress Reports (CPRs)

Progress Reports are an important tool in SAIC's academic support for students. The primary purpose of a Progress Report is to initiate further dialogue between the student and faculty member regarding concerns about a student's progress in their course. Instructors will submit CPRs through Navigate. The secondary purpose of Progress Reports is to make Academic

Advising aware of faculty concerns. Academic Advisors review Progress Reports and reach out appropriately to students when a message (or combination of messages) indicates concern.

Class Progress Reports (CPRs) are used to communicate between faculty, students, and academic advisors to give feedback on class performance. You may receive a CPR if you have missed class, or missed an assignment, critique, etc. These communications are intended to help you understand what you need to do to stay on track or get back on track and succeed in this class.

Accommodations for Students with Disabilities

SAIC is fully committed to complying with all laws ensuring equal opportunities for students with disabilities. Students with known or suspected disabilities are encouraged to contact the Disability and Learning Resource Center (DLRC) to schedule a virtual appointment. During this appointment, DLRC staff will review the student's documentation and work collaboratively to determine reasonable accommodations.

Once accommodations are approved, the DLRC will email a letter outlining the accommodations to both the student and their instructors. Students should be aware that not all approved accommodations will be applicable to every course. It is recommended that students speak with each instructor to discuss how their accommodations may be applied in the context of each class before they are implemented. To ensure timely support, students should contact the DLRC as early in the semester as possible. The DLRC can be reached via phone at 312.499.4278 or email at dlrc@saic.edu.

Student Responsibility in the use of Accommodations

Students approved for accommodations through the DLRC are responsible for communicating with their instructors regarding the use and application of those accommodations. The implementation of accommodations requires an interactive process between the student and the instructor to determine how accommodations might be applied in the context of each specific course. Because course content, assignments, and learning objectives vary, accommodations must be considered on a course-by-course basis to ensure that they are both appropriate and do not compromise essential learning outcomes, which students are still expected to meet.

Accommodations do not excuse students from the standard requirements of communication and attendance. If a student needs to miss class or modify participation due to an approved accommodation, they must communicate with the instructor in advance whenever possible. In situations where advance notice is not feasible, students must notify the instructor within 24 hours of the missed class or academic activity. Failure on the student's part to communicate in a timely manner may result in the inability to apply the accommodation for that specific instance.

Writing Center

Tutors are available in person and online to help students achieve their writing goals at any stage of their writing process. All students are welcome, and they can work on essays, artist statements, application materials, presentation texts, theses, proposals, creative writing, or social media posts. The Writing Center tutors are kind, encouraging, and interested!

Writing Center Hours (CST) Monday – Thursday: 9 AM - 7 PM and Friday: 9 AM - 5 PM

Though drop-ins are welcome, the best way to guarantee an appointment is to schedule one via [Navigate](#).

Email: wcente@saic.edu

Location: 116 S. Michigan Avenue, 10th Floor

Phone 312-499-4138

Academic Misconduct

From the [SAIC Student Handbook](#), page 12

Academic misconduct includes both plagiarism and cheating, and may consist of: the submission of the work of another as one's own; unauthorized assistance (as defined by individual instructors and laid out in the course syllabus) on a test or assignment; submission of the same work for more than one class without the knowledge and consent of all instructors; or the failure to properly cite texts or ideas from other sources. Academic misconduct also includes the falsification of academic or student-related records, such as transcripts, evaluations, and letters of recommendation.

Academic misconduct extends to all spaces on campus, including satellite locations and online education.

Academic integrity is expected in all coursework, including online learning. It is assumed that the person receiving the credit for the course is the person completing the work. SAIC has processes in place, including LDAP authentication, to verify student identity.

Support Resources for Students

The Office of Students Affairs is here to help students achieve success in and outside of the classroom and studios. Staff members are available to assist students with a wide-range of issues and concerns, including mental and physical health concerns, food and housing insecurity, conflicts with others, and much more. We are available during typical business hours (9-5pm, Mon-Friday); however, we also have staff available after-hours to address emergency concerns.

In case of an emergency, please contact SAIC Campus Security, 24 hours a day, by visiting any campus security desk or calling 312.899.1230. They can assist you and/or connect you with a staff member who can provide support for you.

Food and Housing Resources

If you have difficulty affording groceries or accessing food every day, and/or do not have a safe and stable place to live, please contact the Office of Student Affairs - (312) 629-6800 / studenthelp@saic.edu during business hours. If you contact them after hours, someone will respond the next business day.

You can also find links and resources at this site, curated by Student Affairs: [Student Support Resources and Information](#)

SAIC Food Pantry

Spoonful Food Pantry is available to current SAIC students who are experiencing difficulty accessing food because of a financial emergency or ongoing constraints. Students can request a pre-packaged bag of non-perishable groceries (vegan and gluten free available) by completing the online [form](#).

Once approved, students will receive a pre-packaged bag of non-perishable groceries.

Wellness Center

The SAIC Wellness Center, which includes Counseling Services, Health Services, and the Disability and Learning Resource Center, is also here to support students' mental health, physical health and accessibility needs. You may contact them at:

- Counseling Services: counselingservices@saic.edu and 312-499-4271 (press 1 to speak to a counselor after hours)
- Health Services: healthservices@saic.edu and 312-499-4288 (After hours contact the 24-Hour Nurse Line at 877-924-7758)
- Disability and Learning Resource Center: dlrc@saic.edu and 312-499-4278

Grades of Incomplete (INC)

Grades of INC (incomplete) are granted by the instructor only if the instructor believes that the student's reason for the request is justified. Furthermore, students receiving an incomplete should have attended the majority of classes as well as regularly completed assignments prior to the last day to officially withdraw from the class. It is the responsibility of the student to contact the instructor regarding the completion of the incomplete grade. Incompletes must be changed within the first two weeks of the following regular semester, or the grade automatically changes to NCR (no credit).

Extra Credit Policy

There are no extra credit opportunities associated with this course.

SAIC Audit Policy

Per SAIC's Policy on non-credit enrollment, auditing this course is not permitted. Students wishing to participate in this course must be enrolled for credit.

Digital Device Policy

The student use of various digital devices in class, such as laptops, phones, tablets, etc. should be limited only to appropriate use given the format of the class. Use of digital devices in class to do non-class related work will not be allowed or tolerated. Similarly, use of digital devices in class during screenings will not be allowed or tolerated.

If a student has a software or hardware related problem please visit the [CRIT](#) Help Desk on the 9th floor of the 112 S. Michigan (Maclean) Building for assistance addressing these issues.

Artificial Intelligence (AI) Policy

In this course, the submission of any AI-generated work is strictly prohibited without advance, written permission from the instructor. Students are strongly encouraged to consult with their instructor if they are interested in utilizing AI tools (apps, etc.) to develop content they plan to submit for a course assignment. If students are not sure if a tool they plan to use is considered AI-facilitated, they are encouraged to ask their instructor. Submitting AI-generated content without receiving permission from the instructor to do so will be considered a violation of community rules for this course and may constitute a violation of the School's Academic Misconduct Policy.

Ombudsperson

The services of the SAIC Ombudsperson are available to all students, faculty, and staff at SAIC. The Ombuds is a confidential, neutral, independent and informal resource; you may speak with them about any conflict you are encountering at SAIC. The Ombuds will help you explore the conflict and consider options for resolution. To learn more or to contact the Ombuds, visit saic.edu/ombuds.

International Student Affairs

International Student Affairs provides guidance and advising on F-1/J-1 visa related regulations and provides support in the form of workshops, presentations, one-on-one advising, and social events to help international students achieve their academic and personal goals. Students who wish to meet with an international student adviser can schedule an appointment through the

Navigate Student App or desktop site [here](#). Students are also encouraged to email intaff@saic.edu with questions or visit in person during [Drop-In Advising](#) hours.

The Visiting Artist Program

The primary mission of the Visiting Artists Program (VAP) is to educate and foster a greater understanding and appreciation of contemporary art and culture through discourse. As such, the VAP is central to SAIC's interdisciplinary curriculum. Additional information can be found [here](#).

Statement on Academic Freedom

The School of the Art Institute of Chicago is a community of educators, students, and staff whose artistic, design, and scholarly work is characterized, among others, by an ethos of intellectual and imaginative curiosity; the love and production of knowledge, art, and design; and the joy of creating. This ethos can be sustained, and the above learning goals can be achieved, only in an institutional and cultural framework of academic freedom, freedom of expression, and equality; these are the conditions within which learning, research, and creative output flourish. Such a framework also allows members of communities whose speech has historically been silenced to fully and equally participate in the same free expression that has historically been the privilege of only some segments of society. This framework also helps us navigate through conflict and tension—themselves vital aspects of educational, creative, and intellectual growth—and it helps us differentiate between the concepts of tension or offense on the one hand, and those of harm, discrimination, and harassment on the other.